

to both software that is available for no monetary cost at all and at the same time freedom or liberty of the user in using the software. Free software in the second context, also known as software libre or many other names, is - according to the online definition - 'software that can be used, studied and modified without restriction, and which can be copied and redistributed in modified or unmodified form either without restriction, or with restrictions that only ensure that further recipients have the same rights under which it was obtained and that manufacturers of consumer products incorporating free software provide the software as source code'. Often free software of the open kind is also available as free software of the no-money kind. The common mantra associated with free software *free as in free speech, not free as in free beer* would perhaps do a good job of explaining the concept that free software focuses more on liberty, not in price or methodology. So, the next time you hear the term



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free software, saying out loud "Oh awesome, it's not going to cost me a dime", might just make you seem ignorant in front of all your friends, because ironically even though free software is generally available without charge, it is not bound to such a restriction. And over the last decade or so, free software has become a phenomenon not just limited to enthusiastic coders/hackers, but has become a force in the server market, with lots of companies now backing it.

Back in the beginning, during the 1950s and 60s, almost all software was produced by computer science academics and corporate researchers working in collaboration. The software communities back then could actually be compared with today's free-software movement long before the term "free-software" was even coined. The source code, which is the human-readable form of software, was distributed along with the software itself as users would modify the software themselves frequently, to enable it to run on different hardware or Operating systems, and to fix bugs or add functionality. Hence, in this era due to software changes that were a necessity because of compatibility requirements, software was free anyway, and not as the result of an effort by software users and developers.

In the late 1960s, there was an increase in the amount of software being sold under restrictive licenses. Soon, most computer vendors and software companies began charging for software licenses, and enforced restrictive licenses on the usage